

Prolific Relaunch Guide — Getting the Right Sample This Time

Step-by-step with links · July 2026 · Companion to STUDY_OVERVIEW.md §8

■■ THE ONE HARD GATE: the IRB-approved protocol (IRB-25-0462) specifies **U.S. auditors**. **Do not launch a broadened-population study until an IRB amendment is approved.** Everything below EXCEPT the final launch step can and should be done now — including the free eligibility test that proves the new population works.

PHASE 1 — Close out the old study & recover the money (today, ~10 min)

Step	Action	Link
1.1	Open the active study's submissions page	https://app.prolific.com/researcher/workspaces/studies/6a508fe494392aa43ed7a1ac/submissions
1.2	Screenshot the study header showing "2/100" and "20 of 334,976 eligible participants" — this is citable evidence; capture before stopping	(same page)
1.3	Also click "Download demographic data" for your records (aggregate platform data — keep private)	(same page)
1.4	Top-right Action menu → Pause , then Stop study	(same page)
1.5	Confirm ~\$980 released to workspace balance (may take minutes)	https://app.prolific.com/researcher/workspaces/6a4e7265a79f3d33156014d0/finance
1.6	Decide: leave as credit for the relaunch (recommended) or contact support for refund	https://researcher-help.prolific.com/
1.7	Enable MFA on the account (it holds real money)	Workspace → account security banner → "More info"

PHASE 2 — The free eligibility test (today, ~20 min, costs \$0)

This is the trick that prevents a second \$1,000 lesson: **Prolific shows you the eligible-participant count for any screener combination in a DRAFT study, before you pay anything.**

Step	Action
2.1	New study: https://app.prolific.com/researcher/workspaces/projects/6a4e7265a79f3d33156014d4/new-study — name it "DRAFT — Risk & Assurance Screener Test"
2.2	In Audience → Screeners , build the broadened filter set (below)
2.3	Watch the "Eligible participants" counter update live as you add each screener

Step	Action
2.4	Record the counts for 2–3 screener variants (strict / medium / broad). Do NOT publish — leave as draft. Zero cost.

Screener variants to test (Audience → Screeners → search these categories):

Variant	Screeners to select	Expect
A — Strict	Employment status: <i>Full-time</i> · Industry: <i>Accountancy, banking, finance</i> · Job function/role: anything audit/compliance/risk-related the taxonomy offers	Thousands (vs. your 20)
B — Medium	Employment: <i>Full-time</i> · Industry: <i>Accountancy, banking, finance</i> OR <i>Insurance</i> · Seniority: <i>mid-level+</i>	Larger still
C — Broad	Employment: <i>Full-time</i> · Industry: <i>finance-adjacent set</i> · then screen precisely INSIDE the survey (recommended pattern below)	Largest

The recommended pattern — platform-broad, survey-precise: panel taxonomies never map cleanly to "does recurring multi-period reviews." So: use platform screeners only for the broad cut (full-time + finance/accounting industry), then keep your **in-survey screening questions** (rewritten per the IRB amendment) as the true gate: *"Does your role involve audit, risk, compliance, controls, or review work in which you assess the same entity, account, process, or portfolio across multiple periods?"* Prolific permits in-survey screen-outs if screened-out participants are compensated pro-rata or the study description states eligibility clearly — see their screening policy:

<https://researcher-help.prolific.com/en/articles/425224-prescreening-participants>

PHASE 3 — IRB amendment (this week, before any launch)

Step	Action
3.1	FIU IRB (Office of Research Integrity): submit an amendment to IRB-25-0462 changing the population from "U.S. auditors" to "U.S. risk & assurance professionals (audit, risk management, compliance, controls, credit/quality review) with recurring multi-period review responsibilities" — via Topaz/the FIU research portal you used originally
3.2	Include: revised screening questions, revised recruitment text, unchanged instrument (or minimally generalized wording — attach tracked changes if any)
3.3	Optionally align with Dr. Rey / Miguel Aguirre-Urreta first — the amendment doubles as the dissertation's sampling design

PHASE 4 — Relaunch (after IRB approval, ~30 min)

Step	Action
4.1	Duplicate the draft test study; paste the Qualtrics live link; set completion-code handshake (fix the "NO CODE" issue: Qualtrics end-of-survey → redirect to Prolific completion URL — https://researcher-help.prolific.com/en/articles/430328)
4.2	Reward: keep ~\$6.00 / 15 min (~\$24/hr — above Prolific's good-practice bar)
4.3	Soft-launch 10 places first ; check quality of completions in 48h; then scale with remaining budget (~\$980 ≈ 120+ more completions incl. fees)
4.4	Set places to match the IRB-amended target (e.g., 100–150) and monitor via the submissions page

PHASE 5 — Parallel channels (so Prolific isn't a single point of failure)

- **CloudResearch Connect** — same broadened screener logic; guide already in repo (`CloudResearch_Setup_Guide.md`).
- **Negotiated access:** IIA/AICPA chapters, ISACA, RIMS; FIU DBA alumni; your London & Canada contacts (add international scope to the IRB amendment if pursued).
- **LinkedIn outreach kit** already in repo (`LinkedIn_Outreach_Pack.docx`) — retarget to risk/compliance groups.

Working hand-in-hand: you do the clicks (only you have the Prolific/IRB logins); I draft every text artifact on demand — the IRB amendment language, revised screeners, recruitment posts, and the study description. Say "draft the IRB amendment" when you're ready.